International School of Management Studies
Pune – Maharashtra - India

Unit 3: Research Methods
Learning Outcome A-D

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Statement of Authenticity

I certify that the work submitted in regard to this assignment is my own and wherever the works of others have been used to support my work, the credit has been duly acknowledged.

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Executive Summary

India's e-commerce giant Flipkart was established in 2007 by Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi students Sachin and Binny Bansal. Flipkart was formerly limited to selling books online and providing nationwide shipping. However, it has since grown to provide a large selection of goods and is present in about 150 cities. More than 15,000 individuals work for Flipkart, which also accepts credit and debit card payments, cash on delivery, net banking, e-gift vouchers, and card swipe on delivery. Currently ranked among one of the India's biggest online merchants

Topic: -

A study on strategies for maintaining customer loyalty in a Rapidly changing Indian e-commerce landscape: A study on Flipkart. (self)

Introduction: -

A growing digital environment and shifting consumer preferences have caused huge changes in the Indian e-commerce industry. The rise in online buying and digital adoption in recent years has caused a major change in the Indian e-commerce sector. E-commerce businesses face a demanding yet promising environment because of constantly changing consumer tastes, technical advancements, and strong competition. Customer loyalty has become critical for e-commerce businesses trying to figure out a place and sustain the strong competition in this quickly evolving market. In this changing environment, maintaining and gaining the loyalty of customers has become essential to success, and Flipkart, a dominant player in the Indian e-commerce space, provides a fascinating case study. (Rishabh Rathi, Manisha Mishra,2023)

The growth of e-commerce in India is a symbol of the country's ongoing digital revolution. A rise in online shopping has been inspired by the middle class's development, the rise of smartphones, and rising internet usage. But this rapid growth also comes with significant challenges. E-commerce businesses that want to stay in the market must constantly innovate and adapt to the quickly changing industry. (Rishabh Rathi, Manisha Mishra,2023)

The e-commerce scene in India has been strong development and has plenty of room to expand. India is the second largest internet market in the world with more than 800 million internet users, and its digital economy is poised to grow to US $ 1 trillion by 2030. The total e-commerce market is expected to approach $350 billion by 2030, and social e-commerce will likely approach $16-20 billion by FY25, growing at a CAGR of 55-60%. The market, which will soon become the largest base of online shoppers globally by 2030, is growing rapidly by virtue of the rising base of internet users, a favourable market situation and the development of digital payments. Karnataka, Delhi, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and Andhra Pradesh are the major centres in India for e-commerce. The industry is also confronted with obstacles. The regulatory regime is complex. Competition is intense. Infrastructure has gaps. Customer trust needs building and maintaining. The Indian government has introduced policies such as Startup India, Digital India and the BharatNet Project to further the development of e-commerce. In India, e-commerce laws and regulations are regulated by the Indian Contracts Act, 1872, and the Information Act, 2000. (India Brand Equity Foundation,2023)

Service quality, customer satisfaction, and government compliance affect customer loyalty in the Indian e-commerce industry. As a whole, the e-commerce scene in India offers enormous chances for development, due to ever more investment, a rapidly growing market, and the emergence of social commerce. (Rishabh Rathi, Manisha Mishra,2023)

Flipkart plays a pivotal role in shaping the Indian e-commerce landscape. Through its many business challenges and market shifts, it has managed to maintain and grow the loyalty of its wide range of customers. This study aims to identify the tactics Flipkart has used to both adapt to the rapidly evolving Indian e-commerce landscape and to strengthen and increase customer loyalty. (Indian Retailer Bureau,2023)

Strategies employed by Flipkart: -

The Indian e-commerce landscape is dominated by Flipkart, but it has used numerous means to retain customers and adjust to changing times. Some of these strategies include:

In order to retain and increase customer loyalty, Flipkart provides a number of loyalty programs, including cash backs, discounts, and exclusive sales. These programs are aimed at stimulating repeat buying and increasing the quality of the customer experience. Flipkart makes heavy use of data to learn about their customers and provide a personalized service on their site. They also include personalized product recommendations, personalized marketing campaigns, and a customizable user interface. When Flipkart try to obtain consumer feedback, it does so actively. By helping customers resolve problems and incorporating suggestions from existing customers, the firm demonstrates how committed it is to customer satisfaction and loyalty. Flipkart keeps lines of communication open with its customers, providing prompt responses to their inquiries and worries. This creates a feeling of trust among customers and loyalty toward the brand. Flipkart has invested heavily in technology to improve the user experience and functionality of its platform. This embodies enhancements to website design, mobile app performance, and supply chain management that help customer satisfaction and retention. (Aditya Shastri,2023)

Finally, Flipkart's strategies for retaining customer loyalty in the rapidly changing world of Indian e- commerce centre on loyalty programs, personalisation, customer feedback, communication, and investment in technology. These strategies have enabled Flipkart to expand and adapt to changing market conditions, and it has become an important player in the Indian e-commerce scene. (self)

Research

Problem: -

In the dynamic and competitive Indian e-commerce market, what specific strategies can Flipkart employ to adapt to the rapidly changing landscape and enhance customer loyalty? This study aims to identify the key factors influencing customer loyalty in the Indian e-commerce, and to develop actionable recommendations for Flipkart to effectively engage and retain its customer base amidst the evolving market dynamics. (self)

Significance Of the Study: -

The significance of conducting a study on strategies for maintaining customer loyalty in the rapidly changing Indian e-commerce landscape, with a focus on Flipkart, is multifaceted. First and foremost, it is crucial to understand the growing level of competition in the Indian e-commerce sector as well as the significant cost difference between bringing in new business and keeping hold of current consumers. Furthermore, it is crucial to recognise that factors that increase consumer loyalty in this particular setting, including personalisation, reward schemes, and efficient communication. Additionally, investigating how innovation and technology affect customer loyalty as well as how cultural and regional variances affect it can be quite insightful for businesses in this field. This study can directly boost customer loyalty efforts within Flipkart by evaluating the efficacy of various initiatives and creating useful recommendations for the organisation. Additionally, it will broaden our understanding of client loyalty in the Indian e-commerce market, influencing both industry and study debates. Moreover, it can improve comprehension of the development of the Indian e-commerce market and its consequences for foreign e-commerce operators, supporting the broader area of global trade and economic growth. (self)

Objectives: -

To determine whether Flipkart's loyalty programs are effective in customer retention.

To evaluate how Flipkart's loyalty programs influence customer spending

behaviour. (self) Research Methodology: -

Explanatory Research: -

The explanatory research design is well-suited to investigate the causal relationships between Flipkart's loyalty strategies and their impact on customer loyalty.

This design allows for a deeper understanding of the variations and underlying factors influencing customer loyalty in the dynamic e-commerce market.

Explanatory research would be appropriate for the proposed study on customer loyalty strategies in the quickly evolving Indian e-commerce industry. The goal of the study is to find out how well Flipkart's loyalty programmes keep and expand customer loyalty. Explanatory research aims to investigate casual linkages and to understand the root causes influencing an issue. This method allows a more thorough examination of the specifies and workings of Flipkart's customer retention strategies. Explanatory research offers a more thorough knowledge of how loyalty programmes affect consumer behaviour in the ever-changing e-commerce sector by analysing the cause-and-effect links.

Sampling: -
Stratified Random Sampling: -
The stratified random sampling technique ensures that the sample is representative of Flipkart's diverse customer base, capturing the heterogeneity in customer preferences and behaviors.
For this study, stratified random sampling is important since it ensures an exact different sample of Flipkart's customers. Customers may display different tastes and behaviors in the quickly evolving Indian e-commerce market. Using stratification, the population can be divided into subgroups (called strata) according to relevant variables (such as usage frequency or demographics). By ensuring every stratum is fairly represented in the sample, this technique captures the variety of Flipkart's customer base. An understanding of the techniques that are most effective in maintaining client loyalty in the dynamic world of e-commerce can be gained by analysing the effectiveness of loyalty programmes across various customer categories

Sample Size: 100 people
Data Collection: -
Primary Data refers to the main source of data for this study will be information gathered straight from Flipkart's clients and the business. Customer surveys would reveal opinions about Flipkart's loyalty schemes, purchasing patterns, and general satisfaction. Furthermore, getting information directly from Flipkart by internal reports or interviews with employees would be beneficial to gain insight into the planning, execution, and outcomes of their reward programmes. (Dr. Preeti Sharma, Tanuj Manral, Abhishek Pokhriyal, Anjali Gupta, Siddhi Keshri ,2022)

Secondary data refers to pre-existing information that has been obtained from outside resources. These could include news from the industry, scholarly research on e-commerce trends, and publicly accessible data on Flipkart's financial statements, business plans, and previous advertising campaigns. (Dr. Preeti Sharma, Tanuj Manral, Abhishek Pokhriyal, Anjali Gupta, Siddhi Keshri,2022)

Primary data acquired from customers and Flipkart itself, secondary data analysis would offer context for understanding broader industry trends, competitive dynamics, and historical perspectives. In the quickly evolving Indian e-commerce market, the combination of primary and secondary data will provide a thorough understanding of Flipkart's reward programmes and their effect on customer retention. (Dr. Preeti Sharma, Tanuj Manral, Abhishek Pokhriyal, Anjali Gupta, Siddhi Keshri,2022)
Work Schedule: -

1	Project Planning and Proposal	2 weeks	Develop a detailed project plan outlining tasks, and timelines. Finalize the research proposal, including the research problem, objectives, and significance of the study.
2	Literature Review	3 weeks	Conduct an in-depth review of existing literature on customer loyalty in e-commerce and Flipkart's strategies.
3	Methodology Design	2 weeks	Finalize the research design, incorporating mixed-methods with a focus on stratified random sampling. Develop the survey instrument for quantitative data collection.

4	Ethical Approval and Participant Recruitment	1 week	Seek ethical approval from the relevant ethics review board. Initiate participant recruitment, reaching out to Flipkart executives, manages, and customers willing to participate.
5	Data Collection	1 week	Conduct in-depth interviews with Flipkart Personnel to gather qualitative data.
			Distribute the google form survey to the identified stratified sample of Flipkart customers.
6	Data Analysis	2 weeks	Analyse quantitative data, starting with stratum-specific analyse before aggregating results.
7	Results Interpretation	1 week	Interpret the findings from quantitative analyses.
8	Conclusion and Recommendations	1 week	Summarise the study's main findings and their relevance to the research problem. Develop recommendations for Flipkart and other e-commerce companies based on the research outcomes.
9	Report Writing	1 week	Begin drafting the research report, ensuring a clear and logical structure.

Data Analysis

The study's plan to analyze the quantitative data using stratum-specific analyses before aggregating the results is a robust approach to understand the nuances across different customer segments.

The intention to interpret the findings from the quantitative analyses in conjunction with the qualitative insights is a well-considered approach to generate comprehensive insights.

Qualitative and Quantitative data: -

Qualitative Data: - No usage of Qualitative data

Quantitative Data: - Structured questionnaires are used to collect survey replies, which are considered quantitative data. Customer satisfaction, loyalty levels, and the sense of effectiveness of Flipkart's loyalty programmes may all be measured with questionnaire. (Bryant Harland,nd)

The study primarily focuses on quantitative data through structured questionnaires to measure customer satisfaction, loyalty levels, and the effectiveness of loyalty programs, it lacks the utilization of qualitative data. Qualitative data, if incorporated, could provide deeper insights into customer experiences, preferences, and the underlying reasons behind their satisfaction or dissatisfaction with Flipkart's loyalty initiatives. By combining qualitative data, such as customer feedback and perceptions, with quantitative data, researchers could gain a more comprehensive understanding of the impact of loyalty programs on consumer behavior and loyalty in the rapidly changing e-commerce landscape.

The research study conducted by Ms. Bhavya Jain from the International School of Management Studies in Pune, India, focuses on exploring strategies for maintaining customer loyalty in the rapidly changing Indian e-commerce landscape, with a specific emphasis on Flipkart. The study delves into

the significant growth and evolution of the Indian e-commerce industry, driven by digital adoption, changing consumer preferences, and intense competition. Flipkart, established in 2007 by IIT Delhi students Sachin and Binny Bansal, has emerged as a key player in the Indian e-commerce market, offering a wide range of products and services across 150 cities.

The study highlights the critical importance of customer loyalty in the competitive e-commerce sector, where businesses must adapt to evolving market dynamics to sustain their position. Flipkart's strategies for maintaining customer loyalty encompass various initiatives, including loyalty programs, personalization, customer feedback mechanisms, communication channels, and technological investments. These strategies aim to enhance customer engagement, satisfaction, and retention in the face of dynamic market conditions.

Through a mixed-methods research approach, the study aims to identify the effectiveness of Flipkart's loyalty programs in retaining customers and influencing their spending behavior. The research methodology includes explanatory research design, stratified random sampling, and data collection through structured questionnaires to gather quantitative data. The study also emphasizes the ethical considerations involved in research, such as obtaining informed consent, ensuring data privacy and confidentiality, maintaining transparency in reporting findings, and considering the impact of the research on Flipkart and the broader e-commerce industry.

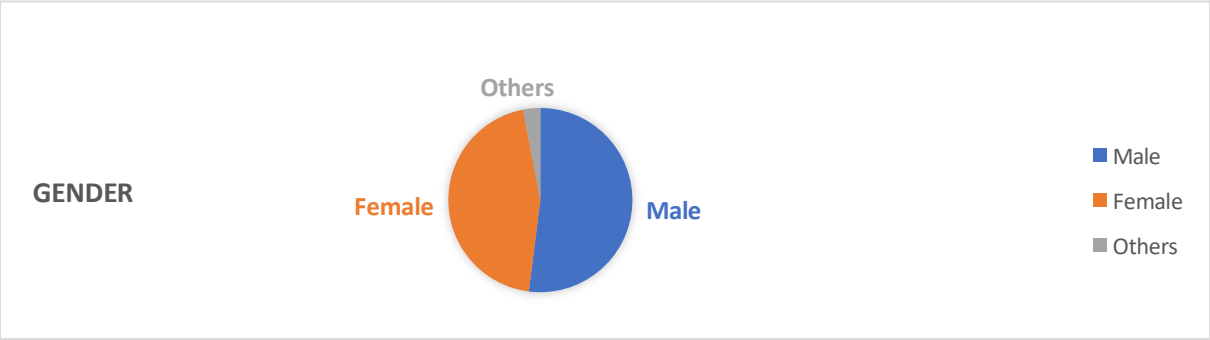
Overall, this research provides valuable insights into the strategies employed by Flipkart to maintain customer loyalty in the rapidly changing Indian e-commerce landscape. By analyzing customer satisfaction levels, loyalty program effectiveness, and the impact of personalized services, the study aims to offer actionable recommendations for Flipkart and other e-commerce companies to enhance customer loyalty and navigate the competitive market environment effectively

Questionnaire:

- Ques:1

	Male	Female	Others	Total
Responses	52	45	3	100
Percentage	52	45	3	100

Gender: -

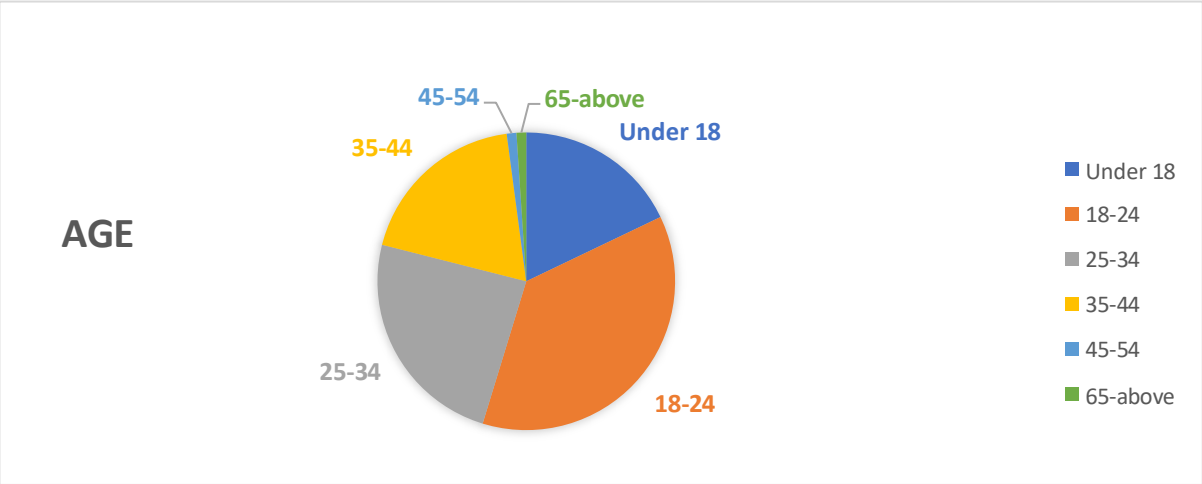


(self)

My target population for this study consists of 52% male, 45% female and 3% others respondents who assist me in filling out my questionnaire. There are 100 responders in all from these categories. Therefore, even though all genders shop online, the survey's results indicate that men are more likely than women to be interested in doing so. (self)

Ques:2 Age: -

	Under 18	18-24	25-34	35-44	45-54	55-64	65 above	Total
Responses	17	35	23	18	5	1	1	100
Percentage	17	35	23	18	5	1	1	100



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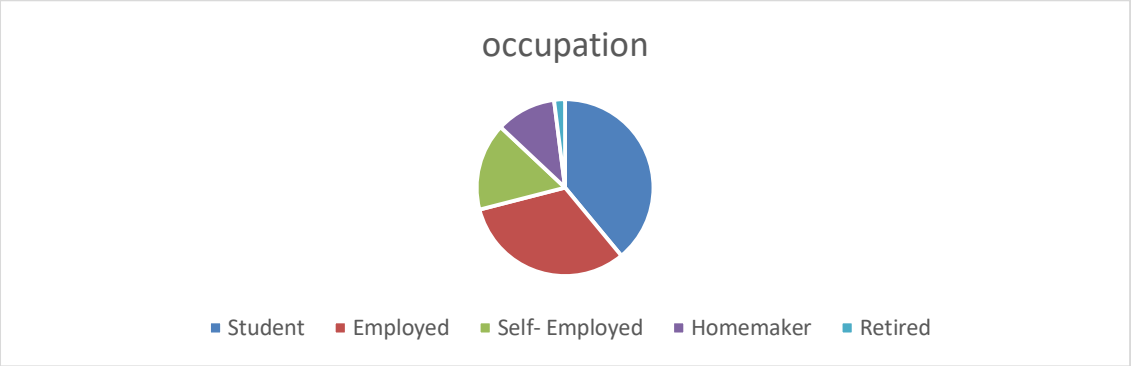
According the data, the age group of 8-24 respondents made up 35% of the total, while the age group of 25-34 respondents made up 23%. This implies that young adults are well-represented in the sample.

On the other hand, the older age groups-55 and up, in particular-show smaller percentages;

only 1% of the responses fall into the 65 and over category. The results show a significant age skew in the dataset, highlighting the significance of taking generational variations into account when analysing survey data. (self)

Ques:3 Occupation: -

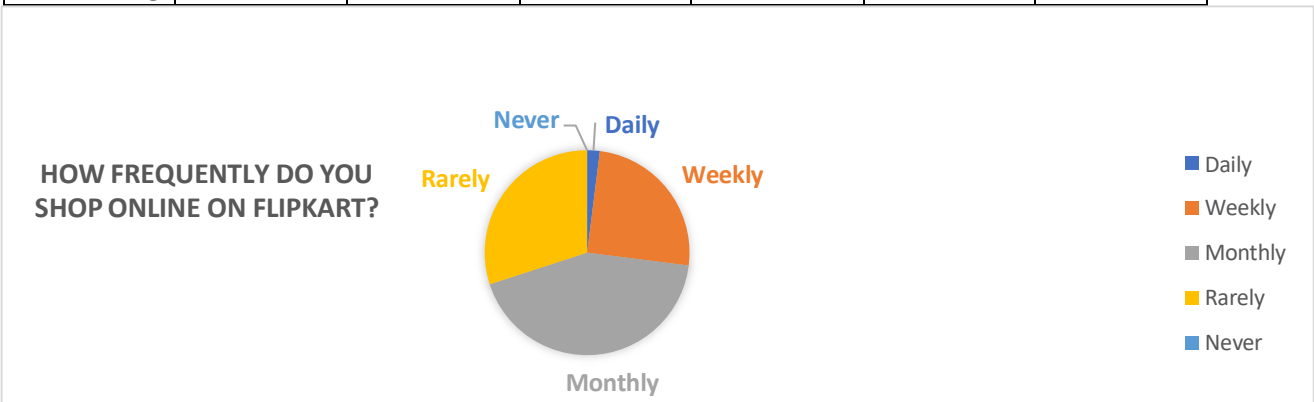
	Student	Employed	Self-employed	Homemaker	Retired	Total
Responses	39	32	16	11	2	100
Percentage	39	32	16	11	2	100



A varied representation is shown by the survey's statistics on respondent's occupations. 39% of the population is made up of students, which represents the younger demographic's engagement. 32% of people working, which suggests a sizable presence in the labour force. Of the responders, 16% work for themselves, demonstrating their interest in entrepreneurship. 11% of the people are homemakers, highlighting the role of individuals in handling domestic matters. The sample includes 2% of retired individuals, representing a tiny but significant portion of the population in retirement. The data's occupational diversity offers insightful information on the diverse viewpoints and requirements of various market segments, advancing our understanding of customer loyalty dynamics in the quickly changing Indian e-commerce market. (self)

Ques:4 How frequently do you shop online on Flipkart?

	Daily	Weekly	Monthly	Rarely	Never	Total
Responses	2	25	43	30	0	100
Percentage	2	25	43	30	0	100



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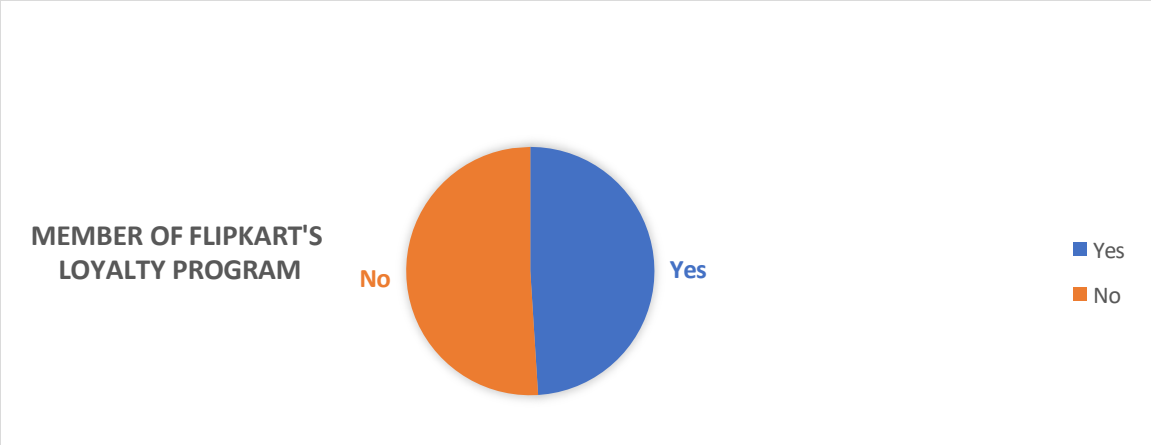
The Flipkart study results regarding the frequency of online buying reveal a varied range of consumer behaviour patterns. Of these, 43% shop once a month, which indicates that they use

of platform consistently and on a regular basis. In the meantime, 25% of users shop once a week, indicating a sizeable portion of consumers that make frequent purchases. It is interesting to note that 30% of respondents rarely buy, suggesting a less engaged group. The results demonstrate that Flipkart serves a wide range of consumer purchasing preferences, highlighting the significance of comprehending and customising tactics to satisfy the diverse demands of its user base. (self)

Ques: 5 Are you a member of Flipkart's Loyalty Program?

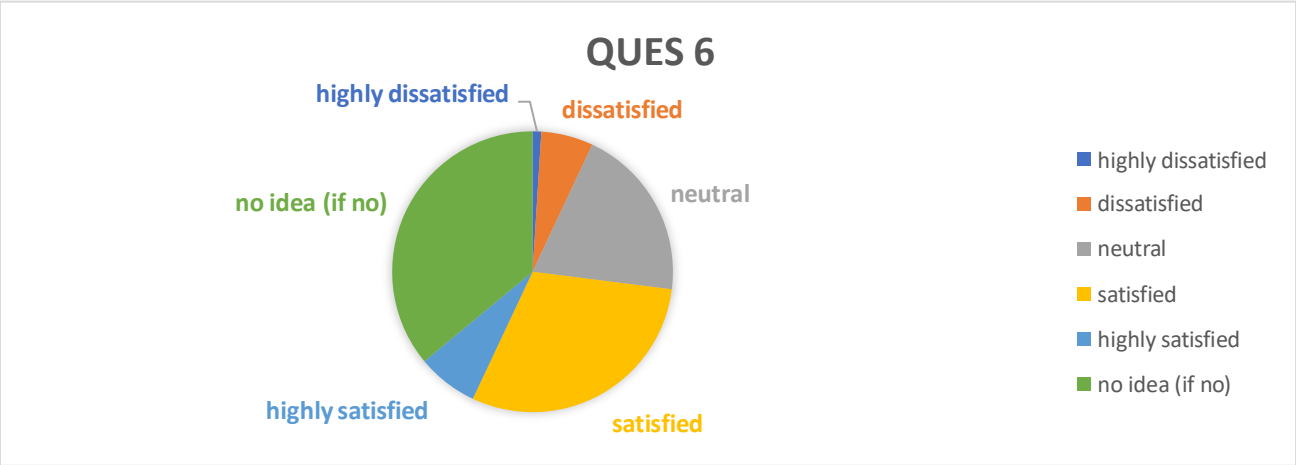
	Yes	No	Total
Responses	49	51	100
Percentage	49	51	100



The distribution of respondents to the study on Flipkart's loyalty programme membership is about equal, with 49% saying they are members and 51% saying they are not. This even distribution points to a varied customer that includes both devoted participants and non-participants. It would be essential its loyalty programmes. This outcome highlights the necessity for Flipkart to consistently evaluate and modify its reward programme offers to sustain a competitive advantage and cultivate consumer loyalty within the swiftly evolving Indian e-commerce domain. (self)

Ques: 6 If yes, please rate your satisfaction with Flipkart's loyalty program on a scale of 1 to 5.

	Responses	Percentage
Highly dissatisfied	1	1
Dissatisfied	6	6
Neutral	20	20
Satisfied	30	30
Highly satisfied	7	7
No idea (if no)	36	36
Total	100	100



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Customer satisfaction with Flipkart's reward programme is not universally positive, according to poll replies. Remarkably, 30% of respondents say they are satisfied, and 7% say it is very rewarding. Conversely, 1% of respondents are extremely dissatisfied and 6% are unsatisfied. 20% of the population takes a neutral position. Furthermore, 36% say they do not know, which could mean they are unaware of or do not use the loyalty program. This wide range of responses indicates that although a sizable percentage of customers find Flipkart's loyalty program to be beneficial, there is still opportunity for development to address neutral and negative views and possibly rise awareness among a part of the market that is unaware of the program. (self)

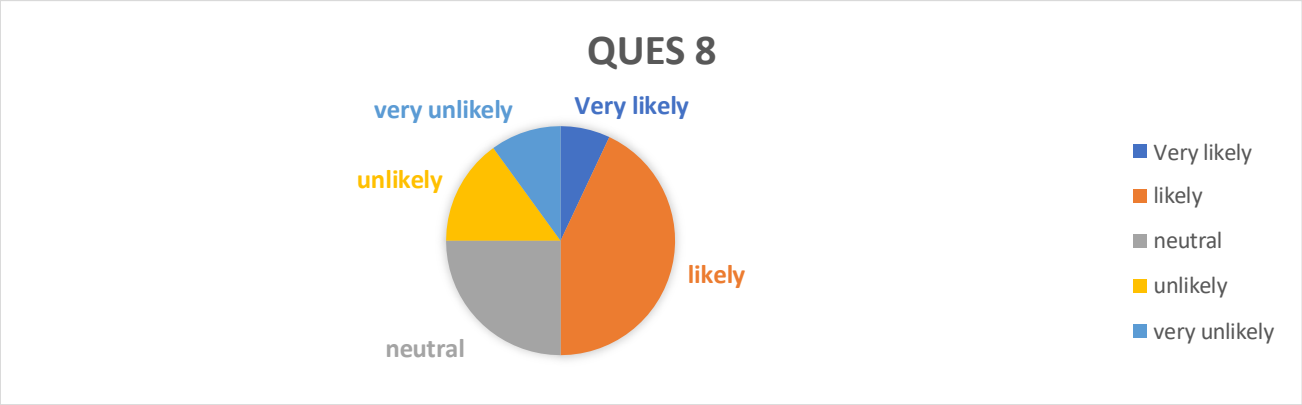
Ques: 7 Do you tend to spend more on Flipkart due to the benefits provided?

	yes	no	maybe	Total
Responses	35	32	33	100
Percentage	35	32	33	100

(self)
According to the poll results, 35% of participants said they usually spend more money on Flipkart because of the advantages it offers. This implies that Flipkart's loyalty intiatives and tactics have a favourable effect on consumer's purchasing patterns. Conversely, 32% of respondents gave a negative response, meaning that even with the advantages provided, they do not spend more money on Flipkart. The remaining 33% gave a response that was ambiguous or neutral. This conflicting opinion draws attention to the different ways in which Flipkart's advantages inpact consumer's purchasing patterns and underscores the complexity of variables influencing customer loyalty in the quickly changing Indian e-commerce market. (self)

Ques: 8 How likely are you to recommend Flipkart to others?

	Responses	Percentage
Very Likely	7	7
Likely	43	43
Neutral	25	25
Unlikely	15	15
Very Unlikely	10	10
Total	100	100



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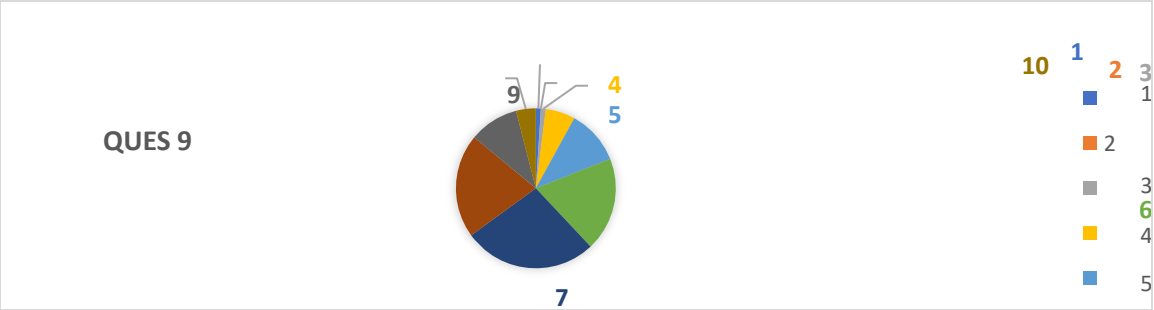
The responses to the likelihood of recommending Flipkart to others indicate a positive trend, with a combined 50% expressing a strong inclination towards recommendation (7% very likely and 43% likely). This suggests a substantial level of satisfaction among respondents, potentially reflecting the effectiveness of Flipkart's customer loyalty strategies. While 25% remained neutral, a lower percentage leaned towards negavtive sentiments, with 15% stating an unlikely and 10% very unlikely likelihood of recommendation. Understanding these sentiments is crucial for Flipkart in refining its strategies and ensuring sustained customer loyalty in the competitive and rapidly evolving Indian e-commerce landscape. (self)

Ques:9 On a scale of 1 to 10, how would you rate your overall experience wirh Flipkat? (1 being

the lowest, 10 being the highest)

	responses	Percentage
1	1	1
2	0	0
3	1	1
4	6	6
5	11	11
6	19	19
7	27	27
8	21	21
9	10	10
10	4	4
total	100	100



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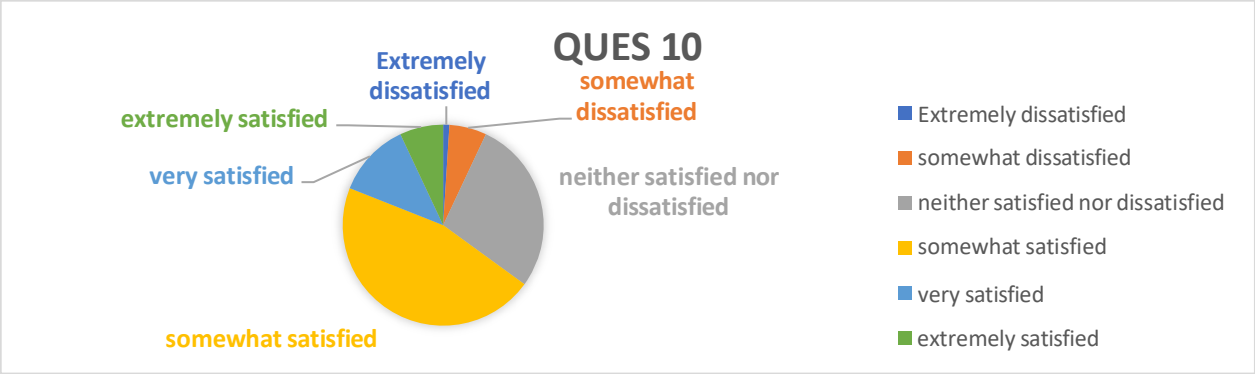
Participant's opinions about their overall experience with Flipkart are overwhelmingly good, according to their answers to the inquiry about it. 27% percent of the respondents gave their experience with Flipkart a rating of seven out of ten. Additionally, a sizable portion of participants- 19% awarded a rating of 6, which denotes a favourable degree of satisfaction. An overwhelming majority of participants (81%) expressed high to very high satisfaction with Flipkart, as indicated by the cumulative proportion of replies from 7 to 10. This excellent feedback seems to be a solid affirmation of Flipkart's ability to give its customers a satisfactory overall experience. (self)

Ques:10 How satisfied are you with Flipkart's customer service?

	Responses	Percentage
Extremely dissatisfied	1	1
Somewhat dissatisfied	6	6
Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied	28	28
Somewhat satisfied	46	46
Very satisfied	12	Page **15** of 12
Extremely satisfied	7	7
Total	100	100



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According to the study results, respondents are generally satisfied with Flipkart's customer service. 46% of respondents said they were just moderately satisfied, and 12% said they were extremely satisfied. Remarkably, 28% expressed neither happiness nor disapproval. Relatively few people expressed extreme unhappiness (1%), while 6% said they were just moderately dissatisfied. The results indicate that most participants hold a positive perception of Flipkart's customer service, underscoring the platform's ability to satisfy customer demands. In the competitive and quickly changing Indian e- commerce market, keeping customers loyal is dependent on this good feedback. (self)

Literature Review: -

Sanjay K. Jain, Manika jain (2011) look at both consumer and product related factors that affect the adoption of e-commerce in India. The results indicate that the most important factor influencing future intentions to shop online is satisfaction with previous online purchasing experiences. Consumer decisions to shop online are also influenced by factors including income, education, and preference for leisure purchases. The report also emphasises how Indian consumers are reluctant to spend a lot of money online and how services with a strong intangible value proposition work well for internet marketing. Marketers could emphasise the fun and enjoyment factor of internet buying while focusing on more informed consumers for their product portfolio.

Anjali Gupta (2014) reviewed on e-commerce in India highlights the industry's substantial growth and potential, which are fuelled by elements like the growing use of the Internet and low-cost PCs. It also emphasises how e-commerce is changing, how traditional and electronic marketplaces are becoming less different, and how hopeful e-commerce is for the nation. The assessment goes on to address the difficulties and prospects facing e-commerce, emphasising the need for user-friendliness, appealing design, and cutting-edge technology to improve the e-shopping experience.

P. Phani Bhaskar; Dr. D. Prasanna Kumar (2015) examines the significance of creating and preserving e-loyalty in online markets. In order to ensure long-term business growth, it highlights how important it is to manage client trust, contentment, and loyalty in e-commerce services. According to the report, e-sellers and e-retailers should concentrate on raising brand recognition in order to boost brand loyalty, emphasizing the connection between repeat business and customer happiness in the context of e-commerce. The results show that India's e-commerce sector is expanding quickly, with a predicted market share and a large number of job prospects. The study sheds light on the variables influencing customer retention and satisfaction in online commerce and offers insightful information about the dynamics of e-loyalty and e-satisfaction in the context of e-commerce.

Madhurima Khosla, Harish Kumar (2017) identified and analysed the major factors that influence the adoption of e-commerce in the past and in the future. Ten factors pertaining to consumers and three aspects pertaining to products were discovered and analysed in total. The most important factor influencing consumer's prior online shopping behaviour, according to the study, is their level of happiness with their prior online shopping experiences. The other four factors that affected a consumer's decision to purchase online are education, previous frequency and contentment with online shopping, and past online shopping satisfaction.

Raj Kumar Singh (2019) identified and investigated the main factors influencing the adoption of e-commerce in India, considering both previous and future intentions for online buying. According to the survey, the most important factors influencing future intentions to shop online are contentment with previous encounters, followed by frequency and knowledge. In order to increase the adoption of e-commerce, the study highlights the significance of marketing goods and services to consumers who are more educated and emphasising the enjoyment and fun factor of online purchasing. The study also emphasises how important it is for customers to be aware of deals and low prices from burden retailers, how important it is for online marketplaces to enhance risk management in fraud and cyber security, how important it is for cashless transactions to draw in clients and boost online traffic, and how important it is to reduce paperwork and paperwork.

Amit Kumar Bhanja, P. C. Tripathy (2020) discusses the impact of Artificial Intelligence (AI), Big Data, Influencer Marketing, and Internet of Things (IoT) on the marketing strategies of e-commerce companies in India. The study emphasises how important it is for online retailers to develop distinctive business plans that offer greater value to clients overall. According to the study's findings, more interactive platforms, improved and more readable content information displays, product customisation, and digital media promotion will be key components of marketing in the future.

According to Felisia Lilian, Honey Wahyuni Sugiharto Elgeka, V Heru Hariyanto's (2021), evaluated choice quality mediates the relationship between enablers and customer loyalty. This suggests that offering

thorough and transparent advice might help customers make better decisions and boost their loyalty. 179 clients participated in the study, which used a convenience sampling technique. The study's conclusions provided insightful information about how online product recommendations and the effectiveness of product brokering affect consumer loyalty in e-commerce, especially in the market for cosmetics and skincare products.

Dr. Preeti Sharma, Tanuj Manral, Abhishek Pokhriyal, Anjali Gupta, Siddhi Keshri (2022) highlights the benefits of e-commerce in India, including cost savings, enhanced efficiency, customisation, and access to international marketplaces, and highlights its effects on society, organisations, and customers. It also recognises the constraints and difficulties that various stakeholders face when it comes to e- commerce. The assessment goes on to highlight the necessity to overcome obstacles including safe encryption gateways and online payment systems, as well as the fast expansion of e-retailing in India, which has increased by 50-60% over the years.

Neha, Sandra Suresh, Dr. P. Bhujanga Rao (2023) examines, via an analysis of several research, the behavioural lessons, sentimental analytics, and customer behaviour during the transaction. The review discusses the effects of flash sales, the difficulties the Indian e-commerce sector has, and the development of e-commerce in the nation. A thorough examination of the respondent's perspectives on the Big Billion Sale is also included, indicating a largely favourable attitude from them. The results add to the body of knowledge already available on consumer trends and e-commerce by offering insightful information about the dynamics of online shopping and consumer behaviour during the Flipkart Big Billion Sale.

Anubhuti Nigam, Adeel Maqbool (nd) examines the factors that contributed to the 2014 Big Billion Day Sale's failure and contrasts it with the company's most recent Big Billion Sale. The study's foundation is secondary data that was gathered from various online sources. The analysis concluded that Flipkart had not fulfilled its orders, discounts, or promises, and that the sale had instead been the consequence of poor technology and planning. Even its most devoted clients were driven away, and the harm to its reputation as a brand outweighed any financial gains. Flipkart did, however, acknowledge its errors and send a letter of apologies to its customers. Flipkart did, however, acknowledge its error and a send a letter of apologies to its customers. Flipkart's third annual flagship sale in 2016 included a wide array of discounts and deals.
Findings: -
According to the report, feedback on Flipkart's loyalty programmes has been inconsistent. Although a sizable percentage of respondents said that they were satisfied, some replies were neutral or unsatisfied. This implies that even while some customers have found the loyalty programmes to be beneficial, there is still need for improvement to guarantee greater satisfaction and involvement. One noteworthy discovery is that a sizeable portion of participants reported that the advantages offered by the reward programmes cause them to spend more money on Flipkart.

Nonetheless, a sizeable fraction did not demonstrate a commensurate rise in expenditure, suggesting possible weaknesses in the incentives for increased spending across all consumer segments. There is a discernible upward trend in the probability of customers suggesting Flipkart to others, with a significant proportion indicating strong inclinations to do so. This means that Flipkart's efforts to keep customers loyal have been successful in creating positive word-of-mouth and brand support, indicating a high degree of satisfaction. (self)
A high degree of satisfaction was shown by the overwhelming majority of respondents who gave a good rating to their overall Flipkart experience. This implies that Flipkart has been effective in providing its clients with a positive overall experience, which is essential for fostering and preserving loyalty.
According to the survey, respondents have an overall favourable opinion of Flipkart's customer support.

Although a small percentage of respondents indicated dissatisfaction, most expressed neutrality or satisfaction, suggesting that Flipkart's customer service initiatives have generally been successful. (self)

Limitations: -
The 100 respondents that made up the study's sample size might not have adequately represented the range of Flipkart's clientele. Furthermore, there could be biases in the results if the sample isn't totally representative of the larger population.

Because respondents may give erroneous or socially acceptable answers, response bias and mistakes may be introduced when self-reported data is relied upon through questionnaires. Because of the study's cross-sectional approach, which only offers a glimpse of consumer impressions at one particular moment in time, it is more difficult to determine causality or evaluate how loyalty has changed over time.

The lack of qualitative data restricts the breadth of knowledge about consumer experiences and views, especially when it comes to the subtleties of loyalty programme efficacy and customer happiness with Flipkart's offerings. There can still be ethical issues relating to data privacy and researcher bias that need to be addressed, even though measures were taken to assure ethical considerations such getting informed permission and protecting respondent confidentially.

Suggestions and Recommendations: -
Given the importance of customised experiences in fostering client loyalty, Flipkart ought to make more investments in using data to customise its offerings. To improve the overall shopping experience, this includes tailored product recommendations, focused marketing initiatives, and unique user interfaces.
Flipkart ought to assess its loyalty initiatives to pinpoint areas in need of development and boost its capacity to hold onto clients. To better match client tastes and spending patterns, this may entail establishing creative loyalty programmes, optimising redemption procedures, and providing more individualised rewards.

Fostering trust and loyalty with clients requires keeping lines of communication open. Flipkart should keep giving top priority to promptly answering questions from customers and providing feedback so that they feel heard and appreciated during their purchase experience

Flipkart should keep investing in technological advancements to enhance the user experience, since technology is a major factor in forming the e-commerce scene. To accommodate changing customer expectations and preferences, this includes improvements to supply chain management, mobile app performance, and website design.

Flipkart is to take aggressive measures to tackle both neutral and dissatisfied feedback regarding its loyalty programmes. This could involve carrying out additional research to comprehend the underlying causes and putting focused tactics into place to solve customer concerns and raise satisfaction levels.

Skills Required: -

In order to fully investigate Flipkart's customer loyalty in the rapidly changing Indian e-commerce market, one needs expertise in research methodology, specifically in explanatory research, which helps identify casual relationships. Proficiency in gathering data is essential for both primary and secondary sources, necessitating the creation of standardized questionnaires to obtain quantitative insights. Transparent reporting and an awareness of participant rights are necessary due to ethical reasons. To effectively collaborate and contextualize information, one must possess both good communication skills and a thorough understanding of the Indian e-commerce market. The multifaceted skill set of the researcher must include data gathering, research technique, ethical issues, industry expertise, and effective communication. (self)

Research Report:-
To conduct this research on Flipkart's customer loyalty strategies in the rapidly changing Indian e-commerce market, the following steps are crucial:

Step 1: Project Planning and Proposal
The first step involves developing a detailed project plan outlining tasks and timelines. This includes finalizing the research proposal, including the research problem, objectives, and significance of the study. This step ensures that the research is well-planned and structured to achieve its objectives effectively.

Step 2: Literature Review
The second step involves conducting an in-depth review of existing literature on customer loyalty in e-commerce and Flipkart's strategies. This includes analyzing various studies and research papers to gain insights into the factors influencing customer loyalty in the Indian e-commerce market. This step helps in identifying gaps in existing research and provides a solid foundation for the study.

Step 3: Methodology Design
The third step involves finalizing the research design, incorporating mixed-methods with a focus on stratified random sampling. This includes developing the survey instrument for quantitative data collection and ensuring that the methodology is robust and effective in capturing the required data.

Step 4: Ethical Approval and Participant Recruitment
The fourth step involves seeking ethical approval from the relevant ethics review board and initiating participant recruitment. This includes reaching out to Flipkart executives, managers, and customers willing to participate in the study. Ensuring ethical approval and participant consent is crucial to maintain the integrity of the research.

Step 5: Data Collection
The fifth step involves conducting in-depth interviews with Flipkart personnel to gather qualitative data and distributing the survey to the identified stratified sample of Flipkart customers. This includes collecting both primary and secondary data to provide a comprehensive understanding of Flipkart's loyalty programs and their impact on customer loyalty.

Step 6: Data Analysis
The sixth step involves analyzing quantitative data, starting with stratum-specific analyses before aggregating results. This includes interpreting the findings from quantitative analyses in conjunction

with qualitative insights to gain a deeper understanding of the research problem.

Step 7: Results Interpretation
The seventh step involves summarizing the study's main findings and their relevance to the research problem. This includes developing recommendations for Flipkart and other e-commerce companies based on the research outcomes.

Step 8: Conclusion and Recommendations
The eighth step involves drawing conclusions based on the findings and providing recommendations for Flipkart and other e-commerce companies. This includes highlighting the strengths and weaknesses of Flipkart's loyalty programs and suggesting areas for improvement.

Step 9: Report Writing
The final step involves drafting the research report, ensuring a clear and logical structure. This includes presenting the findings, discussing the implications, and providing recommendations for future research and practice.

By following these steps, the research study provided a comprehensive and analytical formal research report on Flipkart's customer loyalty strategies in the rapidly changing Indian e-commerce market.

Conclusion: -
The analysis clarifies Flipkart's approaches to preserving client loyalty in the quickly evolving Indian e- commerce market. Although the platform has employed loyalty programs and other strategies to good effect, neutral and negative attitudes might still be better addressed. Flipkart's effectiveness in delivering a pleasant customer experience is confirmed by most of the respondent's positive overall satisfaction. Flipkart will need to stay ahead of the

competition as the e-commerce sector develops further, which will need constant research and modification of reward campaigns. (self)

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